

Other Data: Online And Offline

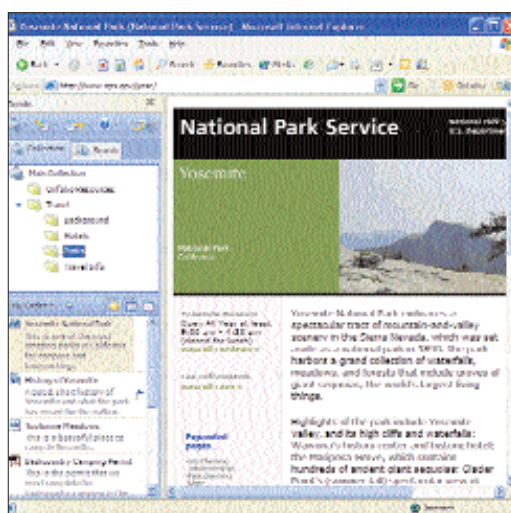
After desktop search made a splash on the computer scene last year, today it's raining search software—and there is no real right choice, since they are all equally up to the basic task. For those unfamiliar with this concept, a desktop search tool indexes your data, or more specifically the metadata tagged to your files, for easy searching. Think of it as running a search engine on your local computer. Search solutions are available from Microsoft, Google and Yahoo!, to list the three most well-known. Each has its strengths.

Microsoft Live Toolbar: Microsoft's solution can be installed as part of either the Windows Live Toolbar or the MSN Search toolbar. Installing the Live Toolbar also gives you access to a bunch of plugins, one of which is Onfolio.

Onfolio itself is worth the price of installing the Live Toolbar. The software was recently bought by Microsoft; what it does is, it lets you collate, manage, search and share online content. Onfolio is an ideal Web browsing companion: it can capture online content and then sort it according to research collections, which can be annotated with personal notes, or attached to documents and e-mails.

You can also collate bookmarks, which Onfolio stores as a searchable database, complete with your notes on the Web sites. It can save local copies of Web sites, spanning multiple links, or saving only select elements therein. It also has a very capable RSS feed reader.

You can add comments, custom fields, keywords and flags to any stored content; searching for content is also made possible via integration with Desktop Search. If you're not too keen on using Internet Explorer to access Onfolio's functionality, you can also run it as a standalone application.

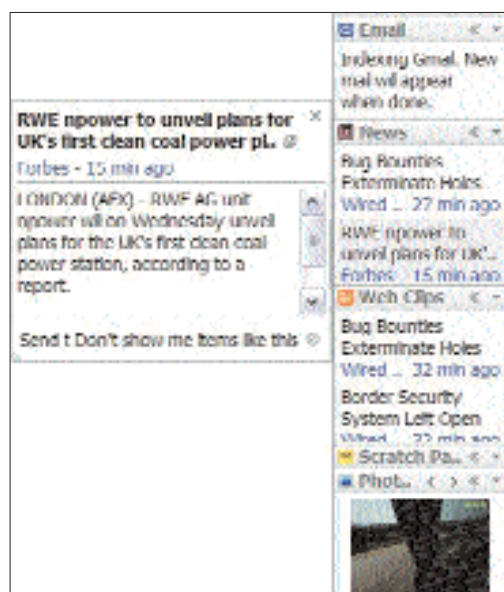


Onfolio can be used to collate a variety of data online

Google Desktop: Google seems to follow the mantra of "what Windows Vista promises tomorrow, today." The latest version of this tool not only indexes your files and assorted data, but also offers the Sidebar, which collates sundry information and content into, well, a sidebar on your desktop. The Sidebar is a single-

Find Your Favourite Tool Here

Google Desktop: desktop.google.com
 Google Picasa: picasa.google.com
 iTunes 6.x: www.itunes.com
 J River's Media Center: www.jrmediacenter.com
 Microsoft Live Toolbar: ideas.live.com
 MSN Desktop Search: desktop.msn.com
 RealPlayer 10.x: www.realmedia.com
 Winamp 5.x: www.winamp.com
 Windows Media Player 10:
www.windowsmedia.com/download
 Yahoo! Desktop Search: desktop.yahoo.com



Google Desktop adds a useful Sidebar

access point to Google mail, Google Talk, Google Web or local searches, to RSS feeds, to Google Maps, and so on and on—a plethora of plugins for the Sidebar ensure that all your bases are covered. Plus it indexes not only your local content but also content from Gmail: that's content from all your local data, over 2 GB of possible e-mail data, and your chat logs a desktop search away. Note that some of these features work by sending data from your computer to Google's servers. Read the post-install notes carefully if you are concerned about your privacy.

Yahoo! Desktop Search: Yahoo! licensed its search engine from the X1 search company. X1 is a powerful search known for its speed, accuracy, and the wide range of data types it supports. All that made X1 so great is what makes this offering from Yahoo! one to consider, if all you are looking for is the best desktop search tool and are not interested in things like Sidebars.

Do note that by default, this offering only searches for a limited and common range of files. To enjoy the support for more than 300 file types offered, you will need to download an additional, free expansion pack. ■

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